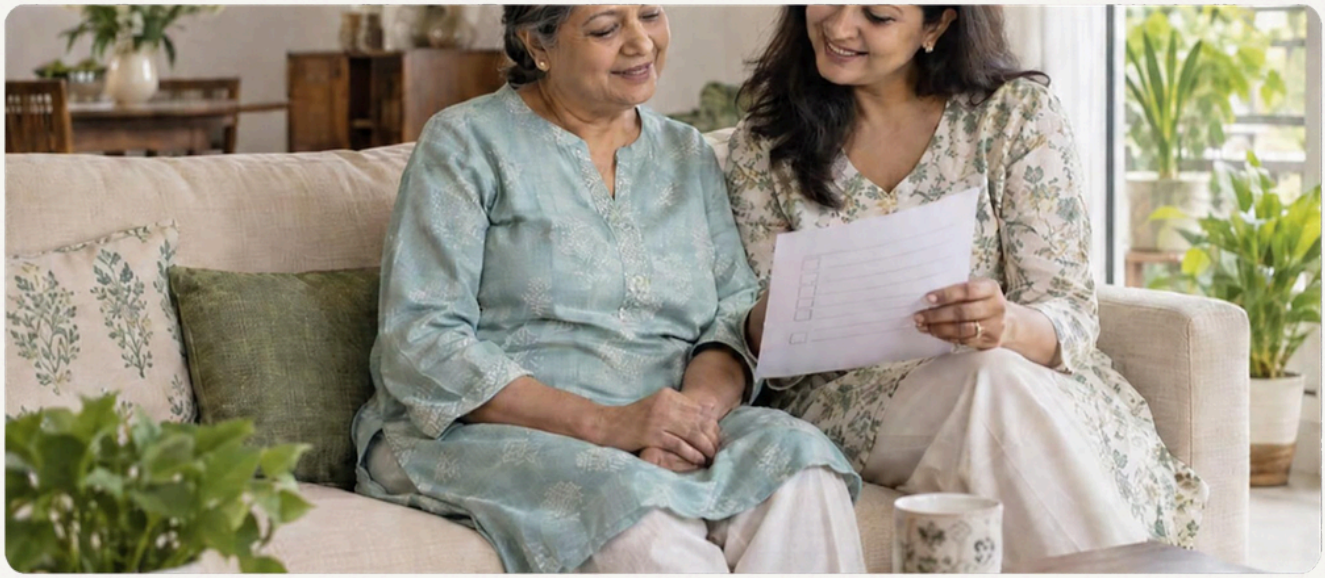
PREPARE. UNDERSTAND. TAKE THE NEXT STEP.

# Your Guide to a Smoother Knee Recovery

Practical steps to prepare for surgery, manage the first weeks at home, and feel more confident about what comes next.



For people preparing for or recovering from knee replacement, ACL reconstruction, PCL surgery, meniscus repair, knee arthroscopy or other knee ligament surgery, and for the family members helping them.

Brought to you by Avana Surgical Systems Pvt Ltd
Recovery products available at osteokart.com, our online store.

General education. Your surgeon's and physiotherapist's instructions always come first.

START HERE

# Your check is a starting point

Thank you for completing the Knee Surgery Readiness Check. Use your answers to notice what is already in place and what you still need to discuss with your care team.

This guide is shared educational material. It does not contain your individual results. A readiness score is not a diagnosis, medical clearance, or a prediction of how quickly you will recover.

## Choose where to begin

- Surgery is ahead: prepare your home and your questions using pages 3 and 4.
- You are recovering now: follow your discharge plan first, then read pages 5 to 8.
- You are helping someone: go through the checklist and contacts together on page 11.

## Choose your next three actions

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Look back at any answer where you felt unsure. Pick one action for today, one question for your care team, and one task a family member can take off your hands.

1. My next practical action

2. My question for the care team

3. The help I will arrange

PREPARE YOUR HOME

# Make the first days a little easier

The first week home is the part most people underestimate. A few simple preparations now mean far less to organise when you are tired and sore.



Clear path, good light, nothing to trip on

- Set up a recovery spot with water, your phone, charger and other essentials within easy reach.
- Clear walking paths. Remove loose rugs and cables, and make sure the lighting is good at night.
- Arrange help with meals, dressing, errands and travel to appointments.
- Keep frequently used items where you can reach them within your movement restrictions.
- Ask your team which mobility aids or supplies you need, and learn how to use them before surgery.
- Keep discharge instructions, medicine details and contact numbers together in one place.

### If surgery has already happened

Ask a family member or caregiver to work through this page with you. You do not have to organise everything yourself, and most people find it easier to accept help early than to struggle through the first week alone.

ASK YOUR CARE TEAM

# Leave with a plan you understand

Take these questions to your appointment or discharge discussion. There are no silly questions here, and asking for written instructions is completely normal.

1. What operation am I having, and what does that mean for my recovery?
2. How should I take my medicines, and whom should I contact if the pain is not controlled?
3. How do I care for my wound and dressing? When may I shower?
4. What movement, lifting or weight-bearing is allowed? Do I need a brace or a walking aid?
5. When does physiotherapy begin, and what should I be doing at home before then?
6. Which symptoms need an urgent call, and which need emergency care?
7. Is cold therapy suitable for me? If so, what device, schedule, breaks and skin checks should I follow?
8. When is my next review, and when should we talk about work, driving and sport?

### A small tip

Write the answers down during the appointment, or take someone with you who can. It is hard to remember instructions when you are anxious, and most people leave with more questions than they arrived with.

COMFORT AT HOME

# Small habits. A clear care plan.

Pain, swelling, broken sleep and needing help are all common after knee surgery. Having a hard first week does not mean something has gone wrong. New, severe or worsening symptoms still need attention.

### Follow the plan you were given

- Use prescribed medicines as directed. Contact your care team if the plan is not controlling your symptoms.
- Rest in the position your team recommends, and ask them to show you how to support the operated knee.
- Balance rest with the movement your physiotherapist has allowed. Avoid adding activity simply because one day feels easier.
- Use cold therapy or a brace only if it is appropriate for you, following the product instructions and your clinician's directions. See pages 9 and 10.

### Keep a simple note

Jot down what feels better or worse, and what you want to ask at your next review. It takes a minute a day and makes appointments far more useful. If something is worrying you, seek help rather than waiting for the appointment.

For warning signs and when to seek help, see page 6.

KNOW WHEN TO SEEK HELP

# Keep this page within easy reach

### Seek emergency help now

Sudden breathlessness or chest pain after surgery needs emergency assessment. Contact local emergency services or go to an emergency department. Do not wait for a WhatsApp reply.

### Contact your surgical team promptly

- New calf pain, tenderness or increasing swelling in the leg.
- Fever or chills, increasing redness around the wound, or fluid draining from it.
- Pain that becomes markedly worse, or is not controlled by the prescribed plan.

Follow the hospital's full list of warning signs and any temperature threshold they give you. This page is not a complete list. If you cannot reach your team and your symptoms are concerning, seek urgent medical care.

### Write your numbers here

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Hospital / surgical team telephone

After-hours contact

Avana Surgical Systems and osteokart.com provide product support only. We are not an emergency or medical advice service. Source: AAOS [1], see page 13.

REST AND REHABILITATION

# Recover at your own pace

### Make room for rest

Ask your care team to show you a safe sleeping position for your procedure, including any brace instructions. Keep the room calm and your essentials nearby. Broken sleep is common in the early weeks, but tell your team if pain is repeatedly keeping you awake. It is worth mentioning, not worth enduring quietly.

### Follow your own movement plan

Your physiotherapist will guide the exercises, frequency and progression that fit your operation. Do not substitute online exercise videos or someone else's routine, even if their surgery sounds like yours.

Ask what discomfort is expected and when you should stop. Sharp or increasing pain is a reason to pause and check with your team.

### Avoid the common setbacks

- Doing much more on a good day without checking your limits.
- Skipping follow-up appointments, or changing your rehabilitation on your own.
- Measuring your progress against someone else's recovery.

### One useful question

"What should I continue, and what should I change before our next appointment?"

UNDERSTAND THE JOURNEY

# Think in phases, not fixed deadlines

Knee replacement, ACL reconstruction, PCL surgery, meniscus repair and arthroscopy all follow different plans. Even two people having the same operation may progress differently.




1. **Prepare and protect**
   Understand the operation, arrange help and learn your restrictions. After surgery, follow the wound-care and symptom-management plan.

2. **Build a routine**
   Settle into the prescribed balance of rest, allowed movement, medicines and appointments. Ask for help where you need it.

3. **Progress with your team**
   Change activity or exercises when your surgeon or physiotherapist advises. Progress depends on your procedure and assessment, not only the calendar.

4. **Return to your activities**
   Discuss work, driving, lifting and sport separately. Feeling more comfortable is not the same as being cleared for every activity.

**Your next milestone**
Ask your team: "What are we working towards, and how will you decide I am ready?"

COLD THERAPY

# Understand the options

Cold therapy may help with temporary pain and swelling. It is a support option, not a promise of faster healing, and it does not replace rehabilitation. [3, 4]

### Ice packs

Lower cost, simple to start

Warms during use; needs re-cooling or replacing

No setup required

### Circulating cold-water system

Unit, ice, water and a pad

May make repeated cold application more convenient

Needs setup and monitoring

Suitability and cost should guide the choice, together with your clinician's advice. Some people manage perfectly well with ice packs; others find a circulating system easier to keep up with. [3]

### Safe use matters [4]

- Follow the prescribed session length, breaks and skin checks.
- For Breg Polar Care Kodiak, keep an insulating barrier between the pad and your skin, and keep it dry.
- Stop and contact your clinician if you notice burning, blisters, colour changes or increased pain. Incorrect use can seriously injure skin.

Do not assume "continuous" means unrestricted or overnight use. Ask your clinician about sleep-time use and how the required checks will happen. Tell them about circulation problems, reduced sensation, diabetes or cold sensitivity before use. Read the full instructions supplied with your device. [4]

PRODUCTS YOUR TEAM MAY RECOMMEND

# Two common recovery aids

Which product, if any, depends on your operation and your surgeon's plan. These are the two your care team is most likely to mention.



### Breg Polar Care Kodiak

A circulating cold-water system for use when your treating clinician recommends cold therapy. Often discussed after knee replacement, ACL reconstruction and arthroscopy.

Product photograph: Breg, Inc. [3] The image identifies the product; it does not demonstrate application. See the safety guidance on page 9.



### Breg post-operative knee brace

A hinged brace that holds the knee within the range of movement your surgeon sets, and can be adjusted as you progress. Often prescribed after ACL, PCL and meniscus repair.

Your surgeon decides whether you need a brace, the type, and the angle settings. Illustration only.

### Plan ahead

If your surgeon recommends cold therapy or a brace, arrange it before your surgery so it is ready on your first day home. Confirm suitability with your clinician, then ask our product support team about the right size or pad, setup and availability.

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Available at osteokart.com
Our online store, with delivery across India.

View products

YOUR RECOVERY CHECKLIST

# Tick off what is ready

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## Before surgery, or before returning home

- [ ] My home and support arrangements are ready.
- [ ] I understand my medicines, wound care and movement limits.
- [ ] I know my warning signs and whom to contact.
- [ ] Recommended aids are ready and I know how to use them.

## As recovery continues

- [ ] I am following my prescribed care and rehabilitation plan.
- [ ] I have raised any symptoms or concerns with my care team.
- [ ] My next review and transport are arranged.

## Keep these numbers handy

Surgeon / hospital and telephone

Physiotherapist and telephone

Next follow-up date and time

Family member or caregiver and telephone

YOUR NEXT STEP

# Product questions? Talk to us.

Avana Surgical Systems is the India distributor for Breg (USA). If your care team recommends a product, we can help you understand the options available in India, and you can order through osteokart.com, our online store.

WHATSAPP PRODUCT SUPPORT

## +91 91500 64620

Tap the number to chat on WhatsApp. Mention the recovery guide when you contact us.

### Our product support team can help with

- Product features, sizes, and compatible pads or accessories.
- Setup information and manufacturer instructions.
- Current prices, availability, ordering and delivery.

### What we do not do

We do not diagnose symptoms, prescribe treatment, or decide whether cold therapy or a brace is medically suitable for you. Your surgeon or treating clinician makes that decision.

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Explore recovery products at osteokart.com. You do not need to buy anything to use this guide. For symptoms or urgent concerns, contact your care team; see page 6.

Visit osteokart.com

KEEP FOR REFERENCE

# A companion to your clinical care

Thisguideoffersgeneral educationfor patients and caregivers. It is not medical advice, diagnosis, a personalised treatment plan or medical clearance. Follow your surgeon's and physiotherapist's instructions whenever they differ from this guide.

Product suitability, treatment schedules and return to activity all require individual clinical advice. Cold therapy and bracing do not guarantee faster healing or any particular recovery outcome.

## Further reading and product instructions

1. AAOS: Total Knee Replacement
Warning signs and postoperative care.

2. AAOS: Activities After Total Knee Replacement
Preparation and returning to daily activities.

3. Breg: Polar Care Kodiak
Device information and links to instructions.

4. Breg: Polar Care Instructions for Use
Safety reference, Rev C, January 2024. Always follow the instructions supplied with your device.

Image credits: product photograph from Breg, Inc. The cover scene is AI-generated for illustration; it is not a patient testimonial. The knee brace on page 10 is an illustration, not a specific product.

References accessed 23 September 2026. AAOS knee-replacement material does not define the rehabilitation plan for ACL, PCL, meniscus or arthroscopic procedures; ask your surgeon for guidance specific to your operation.

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